

Advanced Linear Algebra – Theoretical Depth & Relationships

1. Trace and Eigenvalues

For a square matrix A , the characteristic equation is $|A - \lambda I| = 0$.

For a 2×2 matrix, the characteristic equation expands to:

$$\lambda^2 - S_1\lambda + S_2 = 0,$$

where S_1 is the sum of diagonal elements (Trace) and S_2 is the determinant.

If λ_1 and λ_2 are eigenvalues, then:

$$\lambda_1 + \lambda_2 = \text{Trace}(A).$$

For a 3×3 matrix:

$$\lambda^3 - S_1\lambda^2 + S_2\lambda - S_3 = 0,$$

where S_1 equals the trace and S_3 equals determinant.

Thus, $\text{Trace}(A)$ equals the sum of eigenvalues.

2. Symmetric Matrix Theorems

If $A = A^T$ (symmetric matrix):

- All eigenvalues are real.
- Eigenvectors corresponding to distinct eigenvalues are orthogonal.
- A can be diagonalized as $A = Q D Q^T$.

Proof Idea:

$$\text{If } Av_1 = \lambda_1 v_1 \text{ and } Av_2 = \lambda_2 v_2,$$

$$\text{then } (\lambda_1 - \lambda_2)(v_1^T v_2) = 0.$$

$$\text{If } \lambda_1 \neq \lambda_2, \text{ then } v_1^T v_2 = 0.$$

Thus eigenvectors are orthogonal.

3. Matrix Decompositions

Eigen Decomposition:

If A has n independent eigenvectors:

$$A = P D P^{-1},$$

where P contains eigenvectors and D contains eigenvalues.

For symmetric matrices:

$$A = Q \Lambda Q^T.$$

Singular Value Decomposition (SVD):

For any $m \times n$ matrix:

$$A = U \Sigma V^T,$$

where U and V are orthogonal and Σ contains singular values.

Eigen decomposition applies to square matrices.

SVD applies to all matrices.

4. Orthogonal Matrix Inverse

If Q is orthogonal:

$$Q^T Q = I,$$

$$\text{so } Q^{-1} = Q^T.$$

Orthogonal matrices preserve lengths, angles, and dot products.

They represent rotations and reflections.

5. Singularity and Rank

A matrix is singular if $\det(A) = 0$.

Since determinant equals the product of eigenvalues,
if any eigenvalue is zero, the matrix is singular.

Rank properties:

If $\text{rank}(A) = n \rightarrow$ Unique solution.

If $\text{rank}(A) < n \rightarrow$ Infinite solutions.

Rank-nullity theorem:

$$\text{rank}(A) + \text{nullity}(A) = n.$$

6. Orthogonal Complement and Dimensionality

If W is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$ with dimension k ,

then its orthogonal complement $W^\perp$ has dimension $n - k$.

Every vector $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$ can be written uniquely as:

$$v = w + w^\perp,$$

where $w \in W$ and $w^\perp \in W^\perp$.

Projection formula:

$$\text{proj}_{\mathbf{a}}(\mathbf{u}) = (\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{a} / \|\mathbf{a}\|^2) \mathbf{a}.$$